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# *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.*

***The Man from U.N.C.L.E.*** is an American spy-fiction television series[1] produced by Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer Television and first broadcast on NBC. It follows secret agents, played by Robert Vaughn and David McCallum, who work for a secret international counterespionage and law-enforcement agency called U.N.C.L.E. The series premiered on September 22, 1964, completing its run on January 15, 1968. The series led the spy-fiction craze on television, and by 1966 there were nearly a dozen imitators. Several episodes were successfully released to theaters as B movies or double features. There was also a spin-off series, *The Girl from U.N.C.L.E.*, novel and comic book series, and merchandising.

With few recurring characters, the series attracted many high-profile guest stars. Props from the series are exhibited at the Ronald Reagan Presidential Library and at the museums of the Central Intelligence Agency and other US intelligence agencies. The series won the Golden Globe Award for Best TV Show in 1966.

Originally, co-creator Sam Rolfe wanted to leave the meaning of U.N.C.L.E. ambiguous so it could refer to either "Uncle Sam" or the United Nations.[2]:14 Concerns by Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer's (MGM) legal department about using "U.N." for commercial purposes resulted in the producers' clarification that U.N.C.L.E. was an acronym for the United Network Command for Law and Enforcement.[3] Each episode had an "acknowledgement" to the U.N.C.L.E. in the end titles.

| ***The Man from U.N.C.L.E.*** | |
|---|---|
| | |
| **Genre** | Spy fiction, spy-fi, action |
| **Created by** | Sam Rolfe<br>Norman Felton |
| **Developed by** | Sam Rolfe |
| **Starring** | Robert Vaughn<br>David McCallum<br>Leo G. Carroll |
| **Theme music composer** | Jerry Goldsmith |
| **Country of origin** | United States |
| **No. of seasons** | 4 |
| **No. of episodes** | 105 (list of episodes) |
| **Production** | |
| **Executive producer(s)** | Norman Felton |
| **Camera setup** | Single-camera |
| **Running time** | 50 min. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Production company(s)** | Arena Productions<br>Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer Television |
| **Distributor** | Warner Bros. Television Distribution |
| **Release** | |
| **Original network** | NBC |
| **Picture format** | 4:3 Black-and-white (1964–1965), Color (1965–1968) |
| **Audio format** | Monaural |
| **Original release** | September 22, 1964 – January 15, 1968 |
| **Chronology** | |
| **Related shows** | *The Girl from U.N.C.L.E.* (1966–67) |

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# Background

The series consists of 105 episodes originally broadcast between 1964 and 1968. It was produced by Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer (MGM) and Arena productions. The first season was produced in black and white.

It was introduced September 22, 1964, as part of the Tuesday night lineup, but moved to Monday nights, a half hour earlier, the following January.[4]

Ian Fleming contributed to the concepts after being approached by the show's co-creator, Norman Felton.[5] The book *The James Bond Films* says Fleming proposed two characters, Napoleon Solo and April Dancer (later appearing on the spin-off series *The Girl from U.N.C.L.E.*). The original name was *Ian Fleming's Solo*.[6] Robert Towne, Sherman Yellen, and Harlan Ellison later wrote scripts for the series. Author Michael Avallone, who wrote the first original novelisation based upon the series (see below), is sometimes incorrectly cited as the show's creator.

Solo was supposed to have been the focus, but a scene featuring a Russian agent named Illya Kuryakin drew enthusiasm from the fans and the agents were paired.[7]

# Premise

The series centered on a two-man troubleshooting team working for multi-national secret intelligence agency U.N.C.L.E. (United Network Command for Law and Enforcement): American Napoleon Solo (Robert Vaughn), and Russian Illya Kuryakin (David McCallum). Leo G. Carroll played Alexander Waverly, the British chief of the organization. Barbara Moore joined the cast as Lisa Rogers in the fourth season.

Solo and Kuryakin

The series, though fictional, achieved such cultural prominence that props, costumes and documents, and a video clip are in the Ronald Reagan Presidential Library's exhibit on spies and counterspies. Similar U.N.C.L.E. exhibits are in the museums of the Central Intelligence Agency and other US intelligence agencies.

### THRUSH

U.N.C.L.E.'s primary adversary was THRUSH (WASP in the pilot movie). The original series never divulged who or what THRUSH represented, nor was it ever used as an acronym. In the U.N.C.L.E. novels written by David McDaniel it is the **Technological Hierarchy for the Removal of Undesirables and the Subjugation of Humanity**,[8] described as having been founded by Col. Sebastian Moran after the death of Professor Moriarty at the Reichenbach Falls in the Sherlock Holmes story "The Final Problem". But in a second season episode, guest star Jessie Royce Landis plays a character who claims that she founded THRUSH.

THRUSH's aim was to conquer the world. THRUSH was considered so dangerous an organization that even governments who were ideologically opposed to each other – such as the United States and the Soviet Union – had cooperated in forming and operating the U.N.C.L.E. organization. Similarly, when Solo and Kuryakin held opposing political views, the friction between them in the story was held to a minimum. Although executive producer Norman Felton and Ian Fleming conceived Napoleon Solo, it was the producer Sam Rolfe who created the global U.N.C.L.E. hierarchy, and he included the Soviet agent, Illya Kuryakin. Unlike the CIA or MI6, U.N.C.L.E. was a global organization of agents from many countries and cultures.

### Innocent character

The creators decided an innocent character would be featured in each episode, giving the audience someone with whom to identify.[5] Despite many changes over four seasons, "innocents" remained a constant – from a suburban housewife in the pilot, "The Vulcan Affair" (film version: *To Trap a Spy*), to those kidnapped in the final episode, "The Seven Wonders of the World Affair."

## Episodes

### *Solo* – the pilot

Filmed in color from late November to early December 1963, with locations at a Lever Brothers soap factory in California, the television pilot made as a 70-minute film was originally titled *Ian Fleming's Solo* and later shortened to *Solo*. However, in February 1964 a law firm representing *James Bond* movie producers Harry Saltzman and Albert R. Broccoli demanded an end to the use of Fleming's name in connection with the series and an end to use of the name and character "Solo", "Napoleon Solo" and "Mr. Solo". At that time filming was underway for the *Bond* movie *Goldfinger*, in which Martin Benson was playing a supporting character named "Mr. Solo", being an American Mafia boss murdered by the

main villain. The claim was the name "Solo" had been sold to them by Fleming, and Fleming could not again use it. Within five days Fleming had signed an affidavit that nothing in the Solo pilot infringed any of his Bond characters, but the threat of legal action resulted in a settlement in which the name Napoleon Solo could be kept but the title of the show had to change.

The role of the head of U.N.C.L.E. in the pilot was Mr. Allison, played by Will Kuluva, rather than Mr. Waverly, played by Leo G. Carroll, and David McCallum's Illya Kuryakin only had a brief role. Revisions to some scenes were shot for television, including those needed to feature Leo G. Carroll. The pilot episode was reedited to 50 minutes to fit a one-hour time slot, converted to black and white, and shown on television as "The Vulcan Affair".

NBC in New York was not happy with the pilot. An executive wanted to drop the Russian character, Illya Kuryakin, from the cast, but he could not remember his name, saying "K–K–". Felton replied "Kuluva?" and the executive replied "That's it." Felton did not argue as he wanted to replace Kuluva anyway. When later asked who the replacement was, Felton replied, "Leo G. Carroll". The executive said that he was too old to replace David McCallum as Solo's sidekick. Felton explained he had replaced Kuluva, and that it was too late to get rid of McCallum, the contracts already having been signed. It has been rumored for years that the executive in question was Grant Tinker, then the husband of Mary Tyler Moore and later chairman of NBC.

Additional color sequences with Luciana Paluzzi were shot in April 1964, and they added to the pilot for MGM to release it outside the United States as a B movie titled *To Trap a Spy*.[2] This premiered in Hong Kong in November 1964. The extra scenes were reedited to tone down their sexuality, and then used in the regular series in the episode "The Four-Steps Affair".

Beyond extra scenes for the feature film, and revised scenes shot and edits made for the television episode, there are other differences among the three versions of the story. Before the show went into full production there was concern from MGM that the name of THRUSH for the pilot's international criminal organization sounded too much like SMERSH, the international spy-killing organization in Fleming's Bond series. The studio suggested Raven, Shark, Squid, Vulture, Tarantula, Snipe, Sphinx, Dooom [*sic*], and Maggot (the last used in early scripts). Although no legal action took place, the name was dubbed as "WASP" in the feature version *To Trap a Spy*. The original pilot kept THRUSH (presumably since it was not intended to be released to the public in that version). Felton and Rolfe pushed for the reinstatement of "THRUSH". It turned out that WASP could not be used, since Gerry Anderson's British television series *Stingray* was based on an organization called W.A.S.P. (World Aquanaut Security Patrol). By May 1964, THRUSH was retained for the television episode edit of the pilot. Despite this, WASP was used by the feature film in Japan in late 1964, and it was left in the American release in 1966.

Another change among the three versions of the pilot story was the cover name for the character of Elaine May Donaldson. In the original pilot it was Elaine Van Nessen; in the television version and the feature version it was Elaine Van Every. Illya Kuryakin's badge number is 17 in the pilot, rather than 2 during the series, and Solo's hair, after new footage was added, changed back and forth from a slicked back style to the less severe style he wore throughout the series.

With the popularity of the show and the spy craze, *To Trap a Spy* and the second U.N.C.L.E. feature *The Spy with My Face* were released in the United States as an MGM double feature in early 1966.

## Season 1

Vaughn and a young Kurt Russell in "The Finny Foot Affair"

The show's first season was in black and white. Rolfe created a kind of *Alice's Adventures In Wonderland* world, where mundane everyday life would intersect with the looking-glass fantasy of international espionage which lay just beyond. The U.N.C.L.E. universe was one where the weekly "innocent" would get caught up in a series of fantastic adventures, in a battle of good and evil.[5]

U.N.C.L.E. headquarters in New York City was most-frequently entered by a secret entrance in Del Floria's Tailor Shop. Another entrance was through The Masque Club. Mr. Waverly had his own secret entrance, hinted at in the episode "The Mad, Mad Tea Party Affair." The episodes were largely filmed on the MGM back lot.[9] The same building with an imposing exterior staircase was used for episodes set throughout the Mediterranean area and Latin America, and the same dirt road lined with eucalyptus trees on the back lot in Culver City stood in for virtually every continent of the globe. The episodes followed a naming convention where each title was in the form of "The ***** Affair", such as "The Vulcan Affair", "The Mad, Mad, Tea Party Affair", and "The Waverly Ring Affair", etc. The only exception was "Alexander the Greater Affair". The first season episode "The Green Opal Affair" establishes that U.N.C.L.E. uses the term "affair" to refer to its different missions.

Rolfe endeavored to make the implausible elements in the series seem not only feasible but entertaining. In the series, frogmen emerge from wells in Iowa, shootouts occur between U.N.C.L.E. and THRUSH agents in a crowded Manhattan movie theater, and top-secret organizations are hidden behind innocuous brownstone facades. The series began to dabble in science-fiction plots, beginning with "The Double Affair" in which a THRUSH agent, made to look like Solo through plastic surgery, infiltrates a secret U.N.C.L.E. facility where

an immensely powerful weapon called "Project Earthsave" is stored; according to the dialogue, the weapon was developed to protect against a potential alien threat to Earth. *The Spy with My Face* was the theatrical film version of this episode.

In its first season *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* competed against *The Red Skelton Show* on CBS and Walter Brennan's short-lived *The Tycoon* on ABC. During this time producer Norman Felton told Alan Caillou and several of the series writers to make the show more tongue in cheek.[10]

### Seasons 2–4

David McCallum as Illya Kuryakin

Switching to color, *U.N.C.L.E.* continued to enjoy huge popularity. When Rolfe left the show at the conclusion of the first season, David Victor became the new showrunner. Over the next three seasons, five different showrunners would supervise the *U.N.C.L.E.* franchise, and each one took the show in a direction that differed considerably from that of the first season. In an attempt to emulate the success of ABC's mid-season hit *Batman*, which had proved hugely popular with its debut in early 1966, *U.N.C.L.E.* moved swiftly towards self-parody and slapstick.[7] In contrast to other seasons, the fourth and final season had a recurring female character, Lisa Rogers, played by Barbara Moore in ten episodes.[11]

During the third season the producers made a conscious decision to increase the level of humor.[7] This new direction resulted in a severe ratings drop, and nearly resulted in the show's cancellation. It was renewed for a fourth season and an attempt was made to go back to serious storytelling, but the ratings never recovered and *U.N.C.L.E.* was cancelled midway through the season.[7]

## Spin-off: *The Girl from U.N.C.L.E.*

The series was popular enough to generate a spin-off series, *The Girl from U.N.C.L.E.* (1966–67) The "girl" was first introduced during *The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* episode "The Moonglow Affair" (February 25, 1966) and was then played by Mary Ann Mobley. The spin-off series ran for one season, starring Stefanie Powers as agent "April Dancer", a character name credited to Ian Fleming, and Noel Harrison as agent Mark Slate (who had been played substantially differently by actor Norman Fell in the pilot). There was some crossover between the two shows, and Leo G. Carroll played Mr. Waverly in both programs, becoming the second actor in American television to star as the same character in two separate series.

### Reunion TV movie

A reunion telefilm, *Return of the Man from U.N.C.L.E.* subtitled *The Fifteen Years Later Affair,* was broadcast on CBS in America on April 5, 1983, with Vaughn and McCallum reprising their roles, and Patrick Macnee replacing Leo G. Carroll, who had died in 1972, as the head of U.N.C.L.E. A framed picture of Carroll appeared on his desk. The movie included a tribute to Ian Fleming via a cameo appearance by an unidentified secret agent with the initials "JB". The part was played by George Lazenby who was shown driving James Bond's trademark vehicle, an Aston Martin DB5. One character, identifying him, says that it is "just like *On Her Majesty's Secret Service*", which was Lazenby's only Bond film.

The movie, written by Michael Sloan and directed by Ray Austin, briefly filled in the missing years. THRUSH had been put out of business, and the escape of its leader from prison begins the story. Solo and Kuryakin, who had retired, are recalled by U.N.C.L.E. to recapture the escapee and defeat THRUSH once and for all. Rather than reuniting the agents and recapturing their chemistry, however, the agents are separated and paired with younger agents. Like most similar reunion films, this production was considered a trial balloon for a possible new series which never materialized.

Although some personnel from the original series were involved (like composer Gerald Fried and director of photography Fred Koenekamp), the movie was not produced by MGM but by Michael Sloan Productions in association with Viacom Productions.

## Theme music

The theme music, written by Jerry Goldsmith, changed slightly each season.[12] Goldsmith provided only three original scores and was succeeded by Morton Stevens, who composed four scores for the series. After Stevens, Walter Scharf did six scores, and Lalo Schifrin did two. Gerald Fried was composer from season two through the beginning of season four. The final composers were Robert Drasnin (who also scored episodes of *Mission: Impossible*, as did Schifrin, Scharf, and Fried), Nelson Riddle (whose score for the two-part episode "The Concrete Overcoat Affair" was so loathed by Norman Felton that he never hired the composer again, although the music did get tracked into other third-season episodes), and Richard Shores.

The music reflected the show's changing seasons. Goldsmith, Stevens, and Scharf composed dramatic scores in the first season using brass, unusual time signatures and martial rhythms. Gerald Fried and Robert Drasnin opted for a lighter approach in the second, employing harpsichords and bongos. By the third season, the music, like the show, had become more camp, exemplified by an R&B organ and saxophone version of the theme. The fourth season's attempt at seriousness was duly echoed by Richard Shores' somber scores.

## Guest stars and other actors

Apart from Solo, Kuryakin and Waverly, very few recurring characters appeared on the show with any regularity. As a result, *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* featured many high-profile guest performers during its three-and-a-half-year run.

Jan Murray, Patsy Kelly, and Pat Harrington Jr. in "The Hula Doll Affair" (1967)

William Shatner and Leonard Nimoy appeared together in a 1964 episode, "The Project Strigas Affair", a full two years before *Star Trek* premiered. Shatner played a heroic civilian recruited for an U.N.C.L.E. mission, and Nimoy played the villain's henchman. The villain was portrayed by Werner Klemperer.[13] James Doohan appeared in multiple episodes, each time as a different character.

Barbara Feldon played an U.N.C.L.E. translator eager for field work in "The Never-Never Affair", one year before becoming one of the stars of *Get Smart*. Robert Culp played the villain in 1964's "The Shark Affair". Leigh Chapman appeared in a recurring role as Napoleon Solo's secretary, Sarah, for several episodes in 1965.[14]

Woodrow Parfrey appeared five times as a guest performer, although he never received an opening-title credit. Usually cast as a scientist, he played the primary villain in one episode, "The Cherry Blossom Affair". Another five-time guest star was Jill Ireland, who at the time was married to David McCallum. Ricardo Montalbán appeared in two episodes as the primary villain. "The Five Daughters Affair" featured a cameo appearance by Joan Crawford. Janet Leigh and Jack Palance appeared in "The Concrete Overcoat Affair" and Sonny and Cher made an appearance in the third season episode "The Hot Number Affair".[13] Other notable guest stars included: Richard Anderson, Eve Arden, Whitney Blake, Joan Blondell, Lloyd Bochner, Judy Carne, Roger C. Carmel, Ted Cassidy, Joan Collins, Walter Coy, Yvonne Craig, Broderick Crawford, Kim Darby, Albert Dekker, Ivan Dixon, Chad Everett, Anne Francis, Grayson Hall, Pat Harrington Jr., James Hong, Allen Jenkins, Patsy Kelly, Richard Kiel, Marta Kristen, Elsa Lanchester, Martin Landau, Angela Lansbury, Julie London, Jack Lord, Lynn Loring, Jan Murray, Leslie Nielsen, William Marshall, Eve McVeagh, Carroll O'Connor, David Opatoshu, Leslie Parrish, Eleanor Parker, Slim Pickens, Vincent Price, Dorothy Provine, Cesar Romero, Charles Ruggles, Kurt Russell, Telly Savalas, Nancy Sinatra, Guthrie Thomas, Terry-Thomas, Rip Torn, Fritz Weaver, and Elen Willard (in her last acting appearance).

## Gadgets

## Communications devices

U.N.C.L.E.'s security badge; Napoleon Solo's business card; insignia of the evil THRUSH organization, CIA Museum

The characters in the series had a range of useful spy equipment, including handheld satellite communicators. A catchphrase often heard was "Open Channel D" when agents used their pocket radios; these were originally disguised as cigarette packs, later as cigarette cases, and still later as fountain pens.[15] One of the original pen communicator props is now in the museum of the CIA.[16] Replicas have been made over the years for other displays, and this is the second-most-identifiable prop from the series (closely following the U.N.C.L.E. Special pistol).[17]

## U.N.C.L.E. car

A few of the third-and fourth-season episodes featured an "U.N.C.L.E. car", which was a modified "Piranha Coupe", a plastic-bodied concept car based on the Chevrolet Corvair chassis built in limited numbers by the custom car designer Gene Winfield.[18] The U.N.C.L.E. car had been lost after the end of the TV series, but it was found in Colorado during the early 1980s, and it was restored to original condition by Oscar-winning special effects artist Robert Short of California.[19]

## Weaponry

One prop, designed by the toy designer Reuben Klamer[20] often referred to as "The Gun", drew so much attention that it actually spurred considerable fan mail, and was often so addressed. Internally designated the "U.N.C.L.E. Special", it was a modular semiautomatic weapon. The basic pistol could be converted into a longer-range carbine by attaching a long barrel, an extendable shoulder stock, a telescopic sight, and an extended magazine. In this "carbine mode", the pistol could fire on full automatic. This capability brought authorities to the set to investigate reports that the studio was illegally manufacturing machine guns. They threatened to confiscate the prop guns and it took a tour of the prop room to convince them that these were actually "dummy" pistols incapable of firing live ammunition. The actual pistol used as the prop was the Mauser Model 1934 Pocket Pistol, but it was unreliable, it jammed constantly, and it was dwarfed by the carbine accessories. It was soon replaced by the larger and more-reliable Walther P38.

The long magazine was actually a standard magazine with a dummy extension, but it inspired several small-arms manufacturers to begin making long magazines for various pistols. While many of these continue to be available 40 years later, long magazines were not available for the P38 for some years.

THRUSH had a range of weaponry of its own, much of them only in the development stage before being destroyed by the heroes. A notable item was the infrared sniperscope, enabling villains to aim gunfire in total darkness. The prop was built from a U.S. Army-surplus M1 carbine, with a vertical foregrip and barrel compensator, and using army-surplus infrared scopes. The infrared special effect was achieved using a searchlight to illuminate the target. The fully equipped carbines were seen only once, in "The Iowa Scuba Affair". After that, a mockup of the scope was used to make handling easier.

German small arms were well represented in the series. Not only were P38s frequently seen (both as the U.N.C.L.E. Special and in standard configuration), but also the Luger P-08 pistol. In the pilot episode "The Vulcan Affair", Illya Kuryakin is carrying a standard U.S. Army .45 caliber pistol. The "Broomhandle" Mauser carbines and MP 40 machine pistols were favored by opponents. U.N.C.L.E. also used the MP 40. Beginning in the third season, both U.N.C.L.E and THRUSH agents used rifles that were either the Spanish CETME or the Heckler & Koch G3 (based on the CETME).

# Awards and nominations

Emmy Awards

- 1965: Outstanding Individual Achievements in Entertainment – Actors and Performers (nominated) – David McCallum[21]
- 1965: Outstanding Program Achievements in Entertainment (nominated) – Sam Rolfe[22]
- 1966: Outstanding Continued Performance by an Actor in a Leading Role in a Dramatic Series (nominated) – David McCallum[23]
- 1966: Outstanding Dramatic Series (nominated) – Norman Felton[24]
- 1966: Outstanding Performance by an Actor in a Supporting Role in a Drama (nominated) – Leo G. Carroll[24]
- 1966: Individual Achievements in Music – Composition (nominated) – Jerry Goldsmith
- 1966: Outstanding Achievements in Film Editing (nominated) - Henry Berman, Joseph Dervin, William Gulick[25]
- 1967: Outstanding Performance by an Actor in a Supporting Role in a Drama (nominated) – Leo G. Carroll[26]

Golden Globe Awards

- 1965: Best TV Star – Male (nominated) – Robert Vaughn
- 1966: Best TV Star – Male (nominated) – Robert Vaughn
- 1966: Best TV Star – Male (nominated) – David McCallum
- 1966: Best TV Show (won)
- 1967: Best TV Show (nominated)

Grammy Awards

- 1966: Best Original Score Written for a Motion Picture or Television Show (nominated) – Lalo Schifrin, Morton Stevens, Walter Scharf, Jerry Goldsmith

Logie Awards

- 1966: Best Overseas Show (won)

# Feature films

## Theatrical releases of episodes

*The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* rated so highly in America and the UK that MGM and the producers decided to film extra footage (often more adult to evoke Bond films) for two of the first season episodes and release them to theaters after they had aired on TV. The episodes with the extra footage that made it to theaters were the original pilot, "The Vulcan Affair", retitled *To Trap a Spy* and "The Double Affair" retitled as *The Spy with My Face*. Both had added sex and violence, new sub-plots and guest stars not in the original TV episodes. They were released in early 1966 as an *U.N.C.L.E.* double-feature program first run in neighborhood theaters, bypassing the customary downtown movie palaces which were still thriving in the mid-1960s and where new movies usually played for weeks or months before coming to outlying screens.

A selling point to seeing these films theatrically was that they were being shown in color, at a time when most people had only black and white TVs (and indeed the two first-season episodes that were expanded to feature length, while filmed in color, had only been broadcast in black and white). The words "in color" featured prominently on the trailers, TV spots, and posters for the film releases. The episodes used to make U.N.C.L.E. films were not included in the packages of television episodes screened outside the United States.[2]

Subsequent two-part episodes, beginning with the second season premiere, "Alexander The Greater Affair", retitled *One Spy Too Many* for its theatrical release, were developed into one complete feature film with only occasional extra sexy and violent footage added to them, sometimes as just inserts. In the case of *One Spy Too Many,* a subplot featuring Yvonne Craig as an U.N.C.L.E. operative carrying on a flirtatious relationship with Solo was also added to the film; Craig does not appear in the television episodes.

The later films were not released in America, only overseas, but the first few did well in American theaters and remain one of the rare examples of a television show released in paid theatrical engagements. With the exception of the two-part episode "The Five Daughters Affair", shown as part of Granada Plus's run of the series, the episodes which became movies have never aired on British television.

The films in the series:

- *To Trap a Spy* (1964)
- *The Spy with My Face* (1965)
- *One Spy Too Many* (1966)
- *One of Our Spies Is Missing* (1966)
- *The Spy in the Green Hat* (1966)
- *The Karate Killers* (1967)
- *The Helicopter Spies* (1968)
- *How to Steal the World* (1968)

### 2015 remake

A film adaptation of the television series was produced by Warner Bros. and Turner Entertainment, and was released in 2015. Directed by Guy Ritchie, the film stars Armie Hammer, Henry Cavill, and Hugh Grant as Kuryakin, Solo, and Waverly, respectively.[27] Filming began in September 2013,[28] and the movie was released on August 14, 2015. The film received generally positive to mixed reviews.[29]

## In other media

### Soundtrack albums

Although album recordings of the series had been made by Hugo Montenegro and many orchestras covered versions of the title theme, it wasn't until 2002 that the first of three double-disc albums of original music from the series were released through *Film Score Monthly* (FSM).

#### *The Man From U.N.C.L.E.*

**Disc 1**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "First Season Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith | :45 |
| 2. | "The Vulcan Affair" | Jerry Goldsmith | 14:01 |
| 3. | "The Deadly Games Affair" | Jerry Goldsmith | 11:48 |
| 4. | "The Double Affair" | Morton Stevens | 6:51 |
| 5. | "The Project Strigas Affair" | Walter Scharf | 7:14 |
| 6. | "The King of Knaves Affair" | Jerry Goldsmith | 12:22 |
| 7. | "The Fiddlesticks Affair" | Lalo Schifrin | 6:30 |
| 8. | "Meet Mr. Solo" | Jerry Goldsmith | 2:05 |
| 9. | "First Season End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith | :49 |
| 10. | "Second Season End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Lalo Schifrin | :49 |
| 11. | "Alexander the Greater Affair" | Gerald Fried | 13:12 |

**Disc 2**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "The Foxes and Hounds Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 5:16 |
| 2. | "The Discothèque Affair" | Gerald Fried | 8:49 |
| 3. | "The Re-Collectors Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 6:29 |
| 4. | "The Arabian Affair" | Gerald Fried | 5:29 |
| 5. | "The Tigers Are Coming Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 4:20 |
| 6. | "The Cherry Blossom Affair" | Gerald Fried | 5:12 |
| 7. | "The Dippy Blonde Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 7:50 |
| 8. | "Third Season End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Gerald Fried | :39 |
| 9. | "The Her Master's Voice Affair" | Gerald Fried | 4:50 |
| 10. | "The Monks of St. Thomas Affair" | Gerald Fried | 7:37 |
| 11. | "The Pop Art Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 4:50 |
| 12. | "Fourth Season Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. unknown | :32 |
| 13. | "The Summit-Five Affair" | Richard Shores | 5:52 |
| 14. | "The "J" for Judas Affair" | Richard Shores | 8:03 |

### *The Man From U.N.C.L.E. Volume 2*

**Disc 1**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "First Season End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith | 1:16 |
| 2. | "The Vulcan Affair, suite No.2" | Jerry Goldsmith | 9:59 |
| 3. | "The Iowa Scuba Affair" | Morton Stevens | 6:54 |
| 4. | "The Shark Affair" | Walter Scharf | 7:55 |
| 5. | "The Deadly Games Affair, suite No.2" | Jerry Goldsmith | 3:40 |
| 6. | "Meet Mr. Solo" | Jerry Goldsmith | 1:45 |
| 7. | "The Giuoco Piano Affair" | Walter Scharf | 3:23 |
| 8. | "The King of Knaves Affair, suite No.2" | Jerry Goldsmith | 3:40 |
| 9. | "First Season Main Title" (revised) | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Morton Stevens | :56 |
| 10. | "The Deadly Decoy Affair" | Walter Scharf | 4:32 |
| 11. | "The Spy With My Face" | Morton Stevens | 5:12 |
| 12. | "Second Season Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Lalo Schifrin | :37 |
| 13. | "Alexander the Greater Affair" | Gerald Fried | 1:25 |
| 14. | "The Ultimate Computer Affair" | Lalo Schifrin | 5:00 |
| 15. | "The Very Important Zombie Affair" | Gerald Fried | 4:10 |
| 16. | "The Dippy Blonde Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 2:01 |
| 17. | "The Deadly Goddess Affair" | Gerald Fried | 2:31 |
| 18. | "The Moonglow Affair" | Gerald Fried | 7:09 |

**Disc 2**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "One of Our Spies is Missing" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Gerald Fried | 3:08 |
| 2. | "Third Season Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Gerald Fried | :31 |
| 3. | "The Sort of Do-It-Yourself Dreadful Affair" | Gerald Fried | 6:39 |
| 4. | "The Galatea Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 5:36 |
| 5. | "The Pop Art Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 4:34 |
| 6. | "The Come With Me to the Casbah Affair" | Gerald Fried | 4:16 |
| 7. | "The Off-Broadway Affair" | Gerald Fried | 7:12 |
| 8. | "The Concrete Overcoat Affair" | Nelson Riddle | 6:48 |
| 9. | "The Napoleon's Tomb Affair" | Gerald Fried | 5:17 |
| 10. | "Fourth Season Main Title" (alternate) | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Gerald Fried | :37 |
| 11. | "Fourth Season End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | :36 |
| 12. | "The Test Tube Killer Affair" | Gerald Fried | 7:05 |
| 13. | "The Prince of Darkness Affair" | Richard Shores | 11:39 |
| 14. | "The Seven Wonders of the World Affair" | Richard Shores | 11:46 |

***The Man From U.N.C.L.E. Volume 3: Featuring The Girl From U.N.C.L.E.***

**Disc 1**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "First Season Main Title" (extended) | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Morton Stevens | 1:00 |
| 2. | "Jerry Goldsmith Medley" | | 2:57 |
| 3. | "The Quadripartite Affair" | Walter Scharf | 3:27 |
| 4. | "The Double Affair, suite no. 2" | Morton Stevens | 6:20 |
| 5. | "Belly Laughs" | Jerry Goldsmith | 2:21 |
| 6. | "The Finny Foot Affair" | Morton Stevens | 4:51 |
| 7. | "The Fiddlesticks Affair, suite no. 2" | Lalo Schifrin | 5:17 |
| 8. | "The Yellow Scarf Affair" | Morton Stevens | 3:35 |
| 9. | "Meet Mr. Solo" | Jerry Goldsmith | 3:03 |
| 10. | "The Spy with my Face" | Morton Stevens | 4:09 |
| 11. | "The Discothèque Affair, suite no. 2" | Gerald Fried | 4:31 |
| 12. | "The Nowhere Affair" | Robert Drasnin | 2:48 |
| 13. | "U.N.C.L.E. A Go Go" | Gerald Fried | 3:05 |
| 14. | "The Bat Cave Affair" | Gerald Fried | 4:42 |
| 15. | "One of Our Spies is Missing" | Gerald Fried | 1:09 |
| 16. | "The Monks of St. Thomas Affair, suite no. 2" | Gerald Fried | 3:46 |
| 17. | "The Spy in the Green Hat" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Gerald Fried and Robert Armbruster | 3:19 |
| 18. | "Gerald Fried Medley" | | 7:21 |
| 19. | "The Karate Killers" | Gerald Fried | 1:51 |
| 20. | "Richard Shores Medley" | | 6:37 |

**Disc 2**

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "*The Girl From U.N.C.L.E.* Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Dave Grusin | :34 |
| 2. | "The Dog-gone Affair" | Dave Grusin | 5:28 |
| 3. | "The Prisoner of Zalamar Affair" | Richard Shores | 6:32 |
| 4. | "The Mother Muffin Affair" | Dave Grusin | 10:59 |
| 5. | "The Mata Hari Affair" | Dave Grusin | 7:44 |
| 6. | "The Montori Device Affair" | Richard Shores | 5:31 |
| 7. | "The Horns-of-the-Dilemma Affair" | Jack Marshall | 2:05 |
| 8. | "*The Girl From U.N.C.L.E.* End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Dave Grusin | :39 |
| 9. | "The Deadly Quest Affair: Teaser" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | 3:57 |
| 10. | "The Deadly Quest Affair: Act I" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | 7:48 |
| 11. | "The Deadly Quest Affair: Act II" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | 9:07 |
| 12. | "The Deadly Quest Affair: Act III" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | 7:24 |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13. | "The Deadly Quest Affair: Act IV" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Robert Armbruster | 8:06 |

### *The Spy With My Face: Music from The Man From U.N.C.L.E. Movies*

FSM also released a disc of music specifically written for the feature film versions of series episodes. *One Of Our Spies Is Missing* and *The Karate Killers* are strongly represented, due to the original TV episodes – "The Bridge Of Lions Affair" and "The Five Daughters Affair" respectively – having been tracked with music written for other episodes.

#### *To Trap A Spy*

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | "Main Title/Solo Strikes Again" (Main Title) | Jerry Goldsmith | 1:19 |
| 2. | "The Kiss Off/Main Title" (Meet Mr. Solo/End Title) | Jerry Goldsmith | 1:54 |

#### *The Spy With My Face*

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3. | "Main Title" | Morton Stevens | 4:09 |
| 4. | "Phase Two/Sub Male/Bugged Bobo" | Morton Stevens | 3:09 |
| 5. | "New Alps/Impostor's First Test/Cyanide Cigarette" | Morton Stevens | 2:52 |
| 6. | "Incarcerated Swinging" | Morton Stevens | 5:01 |
| 7. | "The Real McCoy/End Title" | Morton Stevens | 2:17 |

#### *One Spy Too Many*

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8. | "Dog Fight on Wheels" (Main Title) | Goldsmith, arr. Fried | 2:56 |
| 9. | "Briefcase/Follow That Spy" | Gerald Fried | :55 |
| 10. | "The Three Alexanders/The Great Design" | Gerald Fried | 2:45 |
| 11. | "Farm/Skip Loader/Wrong Driver" | Gerald Fried | 2:28 |
| 12. | "End Title" | Goldsmith, arr. Schifrin | :31 |

#### *One Of Our Spies Is Missing*

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13. | "Main Title" | Goldsmith, arr. Fried | 3:08 |
| 14. | "Go-Go in Soho/Cat Jam" | Gerald Fried | 1:46 |
| 15. | "Duel by Flashlight/Fat Vat/Bridge of Lions" | Gerald Fried | 3:36 |
| 16. | "Love With the Proper Mannequin/Thrush Cycle" | Gerald Fried | 1:29 |
| 17. | "Thrush Guards/The Sacrifice/Jordin's Demise" | Gerald Fried | 2:31 |
| 18. | "Hot Tie" | Gerald Fried | 1:58 |
| 19. | "End Title" | Goldsmith, arr. Fried | :37 |

#### *The Spy In The Green Hat*

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 20. | "Main Title" | Goldsmith, arr. Fried/Robert Armbruster | 2:09 |
| 21. | "Sicilian Style/Sacre!" | Nelson Riddle | 1:22 |
| 22. | "Stilletto Tango/Wrong Uncle" | Nelson Riddle | 1:52 |
| 23. | "Von Kronen/Kit Kat Klub" | Nelson Riddle | 1:29 |
| 24. | "Mr. Impeccable/I Sure Do/Right!" | Nelson Riddle | 1:38 |
| 25. | "End Title" | Goldsmith, arr. Fried/Armbruster | :32 |

***The Karate Killers***

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 26. | "Main Title/Search Party" | Goldsmith, arr. Fried | 2:46 |
| 27. | "Coliseum a Go Go/Arrivederci/Drain Pipe" | Gerald Fried | 3:08 |
| 28. | "Along the Seine/Anyone for Venice" | Gerald Fried | 2:45 |
| 29. | "Snow Goons/Touchdown" | Gerald Fried | 02:30 |
| 30. | "Sidewalks of Japan" | Gerald Fried | 1:40 |
| 31. | "Karate & Stick Game" | Gerald Fried | 1:24 |
| 32. | "Mod Wedding/End Cast" | Gerald Fried | 1:03 |

***The Helicopter Spies***

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 33. | "Main Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Armbruster | 2:01 |
| 34. | "End Title" | Jerry Goldsmith, arr. Armbruster | :25 |

***How To Steal The World***

| No. | Title | Writer(s) | Length |
|---|---|---|---|
| 35. | "Crazy Airport" (Main Title) | Richard Shores | 2:08 |
| 36. | "Trouble in Hong Kong" (End Title) | Richard Shores | :37 |

## Comic books

Several comic books based on the series were published. In the US, there was a Gold Key Comics series which ran for twenty-two issues. Entertainment Publishing released an eleven-issue series of one- and two-part stories from January 1987 to September 1988 that updated U.N.C.L.E. to the 1980s, while largely ignoring the reunion TV-movie. A two-part comics story, "The Birds of Prey Affair", was put out by Millennium Publications in 1993, which showcased the return of a smaller, more-streamlined version of THRUSH, controlled by Dr. Egret, who had melded with the Ultimate Computer. The script was written by Mark Ellis and Terry Collins, with artwork by Nick Choles, and transplanted the characters into the 1990s.

Two *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* strips were originated for the British market in the 1960s (some

Gold Key material was also reprinted), the most notable for *Lady Penelope* comic, which launched in January 1966. This was replaced by a *Girl from U.N.C.L.E.* strip in January 1967. *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* also featured in the short-lived title *Solo* (published between February and September 1967) and some text stories appeared in *TV Tornado*.

In 2015–2016, DC Comics launched *Batman '66 Meets the Man from U.N.C.L.E.*, a crossover with its *Batman '66* series.

## Merchandise

Licensed merchandise included a *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* digest-sized story magazine, board games, Gilbert action figures, Aurora plastic model kits, lunch boxes, and toy guns.[30]

An example of this, the Louis Marx "Target Gun Set", a dart-gun shooting-game released in the form of a quasi-playset, is built around the setting of U.N.C.L.E. headquarters in New York City. Art on the cardboard stand displays both the U.N.C.L.E. and THRUSH logos, and a half-dozen soft plastic figures per "side" were provided, including Solo, Kuryakin and Waverly. The game measures 57 by 18 inches (145 cm × 46 cm); the figures, at 6 inches (15 cm), represent one of the few attempts Marx made at supplementing its 6-inch figure line. The U.N.C.L.E. figures are cast in blue, except for a single (unnamed) figure in tan; THRUSH agents are cast in gray. Marx was released an arcade game licensed under *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.*[31]

Corgi Toys produced a die-cast model of the "Thrushbuster", an Oldsmobile Super 88, with figures of 'Napoleon Solo' and 'Illya Kuryakin' which popped in and out of the car windows firing guns by pressing down on a model periscope protruding through the roof.[32]

## Novels

Two dozen novels were based upon *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* and published between 1965 and 1968. Unhampered by television censors, the novels were generally grittier and more violent than the televised episodes. The series sold in the millions, and was the largest TV-novel tie-in franchise until surpassed by *Dark Shadows* and *Star Trek*.

1. *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* (a.k.a. *The Thousand Coffins Affair*) by Michael Avallone. When villages in Africa and Scotland are wiped out by a plague of madness, Solo and Kuryakin dig up a graveyard and a monster named Golgotha.
2. *The Doomsday Affair* by Harry Whittington. The agents must find the mystery man "Tixe Ylno" before he triggers war between the US and the USSR.
3. *The Copenhagen Affair* by John Oram. UFOs are buzzing Europe, and the U.N.C.L.E. agents crisscross Denmark to find the factory before THRUSH launches an armed fleet.
4. *The Dagger Affair* by David McDaniel. DAGGER fanatics have an energy damper that can shut down electrical fields, atomic reactions, and human beings, and even THRUSH

is panicked. This is the novel in which McDaniel introduced the acronym for THRUSH, though it was never used by any other of the novelists nor on the show itself.

5. *The Mad Scientist Affair* by John T. Phillifent. The agents stop biochemist "King Mike" from poisoning London, then discover his second plan is to contaminate the entire North Sea.
6. *The Vampire Affair* by David McDaniel. Napoleon and Illya don't believe in vampires and werewolves, but an U.N.C.L.E. agent has died, so they must investigate an ancient castle in Transylvanian Romania.
7. *The Radioactive Camel Affair* by Peter Leslie. Solo joins a caravan and Kuryakin threads a war zone to reach a missile base deep in the Sudan hinterlands.
8. *The Monster Wheel Affair* by David McDaniel. The agents canvass the globe and infiltrate a remote island to confirm an inexplicable space station belongs to Egypt.
9. *The Diving Dames Affair* by Peter Leslie. The deaths of two merry missionaries lead the agents to the plains of Brazil and a giant dam with no apparent purpose.
10. *The Assassination Affair* by J. Hunter Holly. Surviving assassins' bullets and a "do-it-yourself murder room", the agents follow THRUSH to desolated Michigan farms and a scheme to starve the world.
11. *The Invisibility Affair* by Thomas Stratton (Buck Coulson and Gene DeWeese). The agents track an invisible dirigible to a submarine in Lake Michigan – and a plot to hijack an entire country.
12. *The Mind Twisters Affair* by Thomas Stratton. People in a college town are unaccountably catatonic, euphoric, and raging. The agents must ferret out who and how before the "experiment" goes nationwide.
13. *The Rainbow Affair* by David McDaniel. The agents consult every classic fictional spy and detective in England to find the world's best bank robber before THRUSH can recruit or kill him.
14. *The Cross of Gold Affair* by Fredric Davies (Ron Ellik and Fredric Langley). Clues hidden in crossword puzzles lead the agents, hippies, and frogmen to a Coney Island death-trap to stop the biggest heist in history.
15. *The Utopia Affair* by David McDaniel. Solo must command U.N.C.L.E. North America while Waverly is on a forced six-week vacation, and an undercover Illya tries to protect Waverly from THRUSH assassins.
16. *The Splintered Sunglasses Affair* by Peter Leslie
17. *The Hollow Crown Affair* by David McDaniel. In the last published David McDaniel's novel, THRUSH Agent Ward and Irene Baldwin from *The Dagger Affair* return in a battle against an U.N.C.L.E. lab chief who has defected to THRUSH.
18. *The Unfair Fare Affair* by Peter Leslie
19. *The Power Cube Affair* by John T. Phillifent

The first *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* novel, by Michael Avallone. Pictured: Robert Vaughn.

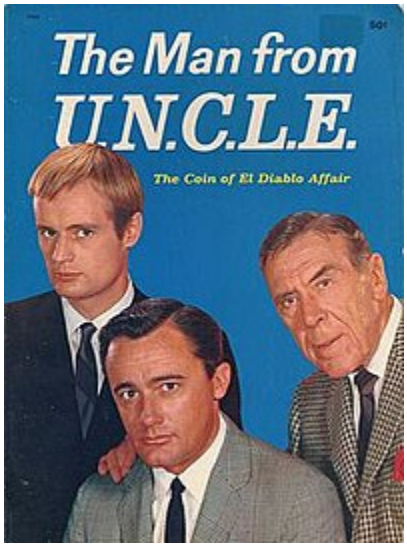
20. *The Corfu Affair* by John T. Phillifent
21. *The Thinking Machine Affair* by Joel Bernard
22. *The Stone Cold Dead in the Market Affair* by John Oram
23. *The Finger in the Sky Affair* by Peter Leslie
24. *The Final Affair* by David McDaniel. Completed but never published, the manuscript has been circulated by fans.

Volumes 10–15 and 17 of the series were only published in the United States.

*The Rainbow Affair* is notable for unnamed cameos by The Saint, Miss Marple, John Steed, Emma Peel, Willie Garvin, Tommy Hambledon, Neddie Seagoon, Father Brown, a retired Sherlock Holmes (aged nearly 100), and Dr. Fu Manchu.

Whitman Books published three hardcover novels aimed at young readers: *The Affair of the Gunrunners' Gold* and *The Affair of the Gentle Saboteur* by Brandon Keith, and *The Calcutta Affair* by George S. Elrick. The first two broke the "...Affair" naming convention used by the franchise on most other TV episodes and book releases.

A children's storybook was written by Walter B. Gibson entitled *The Coin of El Diablo Affair*.



Rare children's storybook based upon *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* Left to right: David McCallum, Robert Vaughn and Leo G. Carroll.

The digest-sized *Man from U.N.C.L.E. Magazine* featured original novellas continuing the adventures of Solo and Kuryakin. Published under the house name "Robert Hart Davis", they were written by such authors as John Jakes, Dennis Lynds, and Bill Pronzini. 24 issues, which also offered original crime and spy-fiction short stories and novelettes, and occasional SF and fantasy reprints under the title "Department of Lost Stories", ran monthly from February 1966 to January 1968. An additional novella entitled "The Vanishing City Affair" was advertised on page 140 of the January 1968 issue for the proposed (but never published) February 1968 issue. It is as yet unconfirmed, however, if this novella was shelved for possible future release elsewhere or if it was ever written at all.

Three science-fiction novels appear to be rewrites of "orphaned" U.N.C.L.E. novel outlines or manuscripts: *Genius Unlimited* by John Rackham (a pseudonym of Phillifent), *The Arsenal Out of Time* by McDaniel, and *Agent Of T.E.R.R.A. #1: The Flying Saucer Gambit* by Jack Jardine (writing as Larry Maddock).

### TV Annuals

There have been four TV Annuals published in UK between 1967 and 1970 by World Distributors which features written stories and reprint of a Gold Key story which were never published in the UK.

## Home media

In November 2007, after coming to an agreement with Warner Home Video, Time-Life released a 41 DVD set (region 1) for direct order, with sales through stores scheduled for fall 2008.[33] An earlier release by Anchor Bay, allegedly set for 2006, was apparently scuttled because of a dispute over the rights to the series with Warner Home Video.[34][35]

On October 21, 2008, the Time-Life set was released to retail outlets in Region 1 (North America) in a special all-seasons box set contained within a small briefcase. The complete-series set consists of 41 DVDs, including two discs of special features included exclusively with the box set. Included in the set was the *Solo* pilot episode, as well as one of the films, *One Spy Too Many*. Paramount Pictures and CBS Home Entertainment released *Return Of The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* to DVD in Region 1 on March 3, 2009.[36][37]

On August 23, 2011, Warner Archive Collection released *The Man from U.N.C.L.E. 8-Movie Collection* on DVD via their "manufacture on demand" service.[38] On November 4, 2014, Warner Home Video released the complete series set on DVD in Region 1 in a new repackaged version.[39] On August 4, 2015, Warner Home Video released an individual release of season 1 on DVD in Region 1.[40] Season 2 was released on February 2, 2016.[41]

In Region 2, Warner Bros. released the complete series set on DVD in the UK.[42] They also released a separate movie collection on September 8, 2003.[43] The DVD contains five of the eight movies, missing the following: *To Trap a Spy* (1964), *The Spy in the Green Hat* (1966) and *One of Our Spies is Missing* (1966).

On March 26, 2012, Fabulous Films released *Return Of The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* on Region 2 DVD.[44]

## *U.N.C.L.E.* in popular culture

### Television and film

In 1967, MGM released a theatrical *Tom & Jerry* short produced and directed by Chuck Jones titled "The Mouse from H.U.N.G.E.R." paid homage to the show, with Jerry as a secret agent tasked with the mission of retrieving a sizeable stash of cheese from the villainous Tom Thrush (portrayed by Tom).

References to the show in popular culture began during its original broadcast when it was parodied in an episode of *The Dick Van Dyke Show,* fittingly titled "The Man from My Uncle". References in other television shows have continued over the years, including a 2010 episode of *Mad Men* called "The Chrysanthemum and the Sword". It has also been referenced in other television shows including *Get Smart, Angry Beavers,* and *Laugh-In*.

The TV show *My Favorite Martian* (1963–1966) also used CRUSH as the name of the evil spy organization, spoofing THRUSH in two episodes. In the season two episode "006 3/4", Tim finds a distress note from Agent 006 of Top Secret, who is being tracked by CRUSH. Top Secret asks Tim to assist Agent 004, to save 006. In the season three episode "Butterball" Uncle Martin must rescue Tim who is kidnapped by Butterball.

A 1966 episode of *The Avengers* was titled "The Girl from AUNTIE".

In a 1966 episode of the sitcom *Please Don't Eat the Daisies* titled "Say UNCLE", the young twins are fans of *The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* and become convinced that their father Jim is a secret agent. In one scene, they watch Jim emerge from a tailor shop similar to Del Florio's. Another man entering the shop asks Jim for a match, and Jim gives him his matchbook. The boys are astonished, because the other man is David McCallum, identified in the ending credits as Illya Kuryakin; they believe their father has just passed a secret message to the "real-life" Illya Kuryakin. The scene ends with the *U.N.C.L.E* scene transition: the action freezes and goes out of focus.[45]

It was also referenced in Glad commercials in the late 1960s and early 1970s, which starred the "Man from GLAD", a trenchcoat-wearing agent who flew around in his combination boat/helicopter demonstrating Glad products to suburban housewives and saving the day.

In 1970, a "secret agent" theme was used by Australian confectionery manufacturer Allen's to market their Anticol cough lozenges, with TV commercials running under the title "The Man From A.N.T.I.C.O.L.", featuring agent "Napoleon Brandy" combatting illnesses being spread by the agents of S.L.A.S.H.[46][47]

In a late 1986 episode of *The A-Team,* Robert Vaughn – who had been added to the show's cast as mysterious retired agent for the show's final season, as part of an effort to revive flagging ratings – was reunited with guest star David McCallum, in an episode entitled "The 'Say U.N.C.L.E.' Affair". This story paid homage to *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.,* complete with chapter titles, the word "affair" in the title, the phrase "Open Channel D", similar scene transitions, and much mention of Vaughn's and McCallum's respective characters having once worked closely together as agents.[48] But in this story, McCallum's agent had turned villainous, selling out to the enemy and now capturing Vaughn to try to find out the whereabouts of a Soviet jet fighter.

Beginning in 2003, McCallum starred in the CBS television series *NCIS* as Dr. Donald

"Ducky" Mallard, M.D., a medical examiner. During the episode "The Meat Puzzle" (season 2, episode 13), as an inside joke, NCIS agent Leroy Jethro Gibbs (Mark Harmon) is asked, "What did Ducky look like when he was younger?" Gibbs responds, "Illya Kuryakin". The photo supposedly of a younger Ducky is actually a promotional photo from McCallum's *Man from U.N.C.L.E.* days.

On the fifth episode of the fourth season of *Mad Men* (2010), "The Chrysanthemum and the Sword", as Sally Draper is watching an episode of the show at a sleepover, she is caught by her friend's mother absent-mindedly masturbating (apparently to David McCallum's Illya) while staring at the television. The episode shown is approximately correct for the year and month (March 1965) the *Mad Men* episode is set in.

*Ben Elton: The Man from Auntie* was a British television comedy series written and performed by Ben Elton. The title of the series was a play on words of both the American spy series *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* and "Auntie", an informal name for the BBC.

A scene from *The Man From U.N.C.L.E.* is shown in the HBO movie *Temple Grandin,* the biographical movie about the high-functioning autistic woman who overcame many of her symptoms to acquire a Ph.D. in Animal Sciences, and in an early scene from the film, Claire Danes, who played Grandin in the film, repeated a line from the episode "The Gazebo in the Maze Affair": "Would you like for me to open the gate?"

## Comic books

Gold Key Comics released comic book series based on The Man form U.N.C.L.E in 1965 - 1969 and it ran for 22 issues. [49]

The 1965–1969 comic book series T.H.U.N.D.E.R. Agents (The Higher United Nations Defense Enforcement Reserves) (Tower Comics), a strange combination of secret agents and superheroes, was inspired by the success of *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.*[50]

The Marvel Universe spy agency S.H.I.E.L.D. and the Marvel Universe terror society HYDRA (both created in 1965) were inspired by the *Man From U.N.C.L.E.* television program.[51]

*The Man from R.I.V.E.R.D.A.L.E.* was a *Man From U.N.C.L.E.* parody in Archie Comics published in 1966–1967. The comic portrayed Archie and the gang as a group of high-tech spies, as part of world-defense organization P.O.P. (an acronym for Protect our Planet). Their chief enemy was a counter-group known as C.R.U.S.H. (a spoof on THRUSH but whose acronym was never explained). Although Reggie, Veronica and Moose were initially cast as C.R.U.S.H. agents, they later became members of P.O.P. All the characters also had undefined acronyms for names (A.R.C.H.I.E., B.E.T.T.Y., etc.). R.I.V.E.R.D.A.L.E. stood for

*Really Impressive Vast Enterprise for Routing Dangerous Adversaries, Louts, Etc.*[52]

## Books

Ted Mark's *The Man from O.R.G.Y.* ("Organization for the Rational Guidance of Youth") series of erotic fiction paperback originals (Lancer Books) was a take-off of *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* The series ran from 1965 to 1981 and inspired a 1970 film. Another 34-title *The Man from O.R.G.Y.* series was published by Paperback Library from 1967 to 1973. Another similar title was *The Man from S.T.U.D.*, by F. W. Paul (Paul W. Fairman), which published 11 titles between 1968 and 1971. Rod Gray's "Lady from L.U.S.T." (League of Undercover Spies and Terrorists) erotic fiction novels were a take-off of *The Man from U.N.C.L.E*; 25 books in the series were published between 1968 and 1975. Other similar pastiche paperback series included *The Man From T.O.M.C.A.T.*, *The Miss from S.I.S.*, *The Man from S.A.D.I.S.T.O.*, *The Man from P.A.N.S.Y.*, and *The Girl from H.A.R.D.*

"Lyra and Bon Bon and the Mares From S.M.I.L.E." is an upcoming title in the *My Little Pony: Friendship Is Magic* chapter books published by Little, Brown, and Company, to be released in March 2016.

## Music

Musical examples include Elvis Costello's 1980 album *Get Happy!!* and an Argentinian funk duo who took the name Illya Kuryaki and the Valderramas honoring the fictitious spy. Alma Cogan paid a similar tribute to the Russian agent in her single "Love Ya Illya", released in 1966 under the pseudonym "Angela and the Fans". In the 1980s, The Cleaners from Venus penned "Ilya Kuryakin Looked at Me"; the song was later covered by The Jennifers. The English 2 Tone band The Specials made an instrumental song called "Napoleon Solo". It was also the name of a Danish 2 Tone band. Space–surf band Man or Astro-man? covered the theme song for their 1994 EP *Astro Launch*. Man or Astro-man are instrumental, not surf however. The British trip-hop group U.N.K.L.E. derive their name from the show.

## Video games

The protagonist in the spy-fi video games *The Operative: No One Lives Forever* (2000) and *No One Lives Forever 2: A Spy in H.A.R.M.'s Way* (2002) works for an organization known as U.N.I.T.Y. The villains in both games work for an organization known as H.A.R.M. In the first game the main character (Cate Archer) overhears two H.A.R.M. guards talking about how they thought Man from U.N.C.L.E. was a good show.

The video game *Team Fortress 2* (2007) has an achievement referencing the show, named "The Man From P.U.N.C.T.U.R.E."

### Podcast

The fourth episode of the Paperback Warrior (http://www.paperbackwarrior.com/2019/07/paperback-warrior-podcast-episode-4.html?m=0) podcast focuses on *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* novels and their impact on the spy-fiction genre. The show's co-host, Tom Simon, discusses both Michael Avalone's *The Man from U.N.C.L.E. (a.k.a. The Thousand Coffin Affair)* novel as well as Harry Whittington's *The Doomsday Affair*. Additionally, the co-host points to many successful authors contributing to the series' novels and novellas and suggests a three-book series entitled *The Man from W.A.R. (http://www.paperbackwarrior.com/search/label/Man%20from%20W.A.R.?m=0)* by Michael Kurland was directly influenced by *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* series.[53]

## See also

- Illya Kuryakin
- Napoleon Solo
- U.N.C.L.E.
- *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* (film) – 2015 remake

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# External links

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- *The Man from U.N.C.L.E.* (http://www.tv.com/shows/the-man-from-uncle/) at TV.com
- Encyclopedia of Television (http://www.museum.tv/eotv/manfromun.htm)
- "The Man from U.N.C.L.E.: A Retrospective" by Kathleen Crighton (http://www.manfromuncle.org/kcretro1.htm)
- Production history and DVD review of complete series (http://www.dvdtalk.com/reviews/31609/man-from-uncle-the-complete-series-the/)
- A detailed chronology of the show's production (http://www.for-your-eyes-only.com/Site/UNCLEtline1.html)

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